



2023

TRIAL HIGHER SCHOOL CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

DO NOT REMOVE PAPER FROM EXAMINATION ROOM

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Centre Number

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Student Number

English Advanced

Paper 1 – Texts and Human Experiences

Morning Session
Monday, 31 July 2023

**General
Instructions**

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 1 hour and 30 minutes
- Write using black pen
- A Stimulus Booklet is provided with this examination
- Write your Centre Number and Student Number on the top of this page

**Total marks:
40****Section I – 20 marks (page 2)**

- Attempt Questions 1–5
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Section II – 20 marks (page 3)

- Attempt Question 6
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

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Section I

20 marks

Attempt Questions 1–5

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the questions in a SEPARATE writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

In your answers you will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
 - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
-

Read **Texts 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5** in the Stimulus Booklet carefully and then answer the questions.

Question 1 (3 marks)

Use Text 1 to answer this question.

'My way of seeing the world still seemed more of a virtue than a danger, which is how some dangers first appear.'

Explain how Text 1 demonstrates the paradoxes of human character.

Question 2 (4 marks)

Use Text 2 to answer this question.

How does Wakeling use language in her poem to communicate a sense of hope?

Question 3 (4 marks)

Use Text 3 to answer this question.

Analyse how a sense of tension is created in the extract.

Question 4 (3 marks)

Use Text 4 to answer this question.

Explain how the poet represents the nature of yearning.

Question 5 (6 marks)

Use Texts 4 and 5 for this question.

To what extent do Texts 4 and 5 reveal that the search for meaning is a complex process?

Section II

20 marks

Attempt Question 6

Allow about 45 minutes for this section

Answer the question in a SEPARATE writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
 - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
 - organise, develop and express ideas using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context
-

Question 6 (20 marks)

To what extent has your prescribed text informed your judgement about the relationship between desire and human experience?

The prescribed texts are listed on pages 12–13 of the Stimulus Booklet.

End of Examination

Section I

Text 1 – Fiction extract

The Sympathizer

I am a spy, a sleeper, a spook, a man of two faces. Perhaps not surprisingly, I am also a man of two minds. I am not some misunderstood mutant from a comic book or a horror movie, although some have treated me as such. I am simply able to see any issue from both sides. Sometimes I flatter myself that this is a talent, and although it is admittedly one of a minor nature, it is perhaps also the sole talent I possess. At other times, when I reflect on how I cannot help but observe the world in such a fashion, I wonder if what I have should even be called talent. After all, a talent is something you use, not something that uses you. The talent you cannot not use, the talent that possesses you—that is a hazard, I must confess. But in the month when this confession begins, my way of seeing the world still seemed more of a virtue than a danger, which is how some dangers first appear,

The month in question was April, the cruelest month. It was the month in which a war that had run on for a very long time would lose its limbs, as is the way of wars. It was a month that meant everything to all the people in our small part of the world and nothing to most people in the rest of the world. It was a month that was both an end of a war and the beginning of ... well, “peace” is not the right word, is it, my dear Commandant? It was a month when I awaited the end behind the walls of a villa where I had lived for the previous five years, the villa’s walls glittering with broken brown glass and crowned with rusted barbed wire. I had my own room at the villa, much like I have my own room in your camp, Commandant. Of course, the proper term for my room is an “isolation cell”, and instead of a housekeeper who comes to clean every day, you have provided me with a baby-faced guard who does not clean at all. But I am not complaining. Privacy, not cleanliness, is my only prerequisite for writing this confession.

VIET THANH NGUYEN
Extract from *The Sympathizer*, 2015
Corsair
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Text 2 – Poem

and a tree

and a tree is a promise
safe-kept by a seed,
and a tree is a dance
that is swung by the breeze,

and a tree is an engine
spinning only on air
and water and light;
nothing lost, nothing spare,

and a tree is a king
who is topped with a crown,
(and a tree never once
loses touch with the ground)

and a tree is a home
with numberless doors,
and a tree is a world
for an ant to explore,

and a tree is a gift
(for a tree is a lung)
and a tree is a song
that is whispered and sung
by the bees and the birds,
and in rustles and creaks,
yes, a tree is a song
that is sung without words,

and a tree is a lesson
in the meaning of roots,
and how out of the mud
swell the sweetest of fruits,

Text 2 continues on page 5

Text 2 (continued)

and a tree is a story
of hope and repair,
or perhaps more a question;
a wish or a prayer,
for a tree (plus a tree)
shows us how we might share,

and when we should grow
and when we should sleep
and what we could lose

and what we must keep.

KATE WAKELING
commissioned by the *Poetry Society*, 2022
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End of Text 2

Text 3 – Nonfiction extract

Little One

Chapter 1

It was the hottest day of summer, a Saturday in January. I sat cross-legged in my study, surrounded by piles of undergraduate textbooks, flicking through them, leaving light fingerprints of sweat on the pages. Having studied Science and Law for six years at university, I was about to embark on a PHD in genetics, and so was packing my old textbooks away. Seeing myself on each meticulously highlighted page, I sighed lightly, remembering all the time I'd spent, understanding, memorising, and ultimately regurgitating those passages, in cold, cavernous exam halls. The focus was now going to be on experiments not exams, data not grades, discovery not curriculum. Occasionally I stopped to read an extract, which brought back even more memories of lecturers, tutorials and classmates. It was a job well done, graduation with honours, all behind me now.

Mum looked into my room again. She had something on her mind. She hoped I wouldn't notice but it was impossible not to – she had poked her head in umpteen times that day. Having lived with my parents my whole life, I could tell when they were generally busy and when they were 'hovering'. The phrase 'helicopter parenting' could very well have been coined for them and especially for Mum. I knew she loved me, but at times it was at the point of suffocating her only child.

'Mama,' I said, 'What's up?'

Mum stopped and leaned against the door frame. She didn't respond for some time. 'Eh,' she finally said, 'nothing.'

'You keep walking past my door. A dozen times now. It's not nothing.'

She rubbed her hands together pensively. Eventually, she asked; 'Are you busy?'

I returned to flicking pages. 'Matters of world importance,' I replied.

Mum was silent. Failing to sense my sarcasm, she continued to stare at me. After a few moments, I looked back up and met her gaze. It was as if she were assessing me, sizing me up for something. As she gazed longer and deeper into my eyes than I thought anyone ever could, I felt lightheaded. There were generations in that look. Mum's stature was small, and her hands tiny, with purple veins protruding, her fingers beginning to turn in with arthritis. But at that moment she appeared like a giant.

Slowly, almost cautiously, I closed my book. 'Mama ...' I said, '*ela*¹, what is it?'

Finally, she spoke: 'Can you come to my room. I've something to tell you.'

Text 3 continues on page 7

Text 3 (continued)

My stomach tightened.

As I followed Mum down the carpeted hall, a memory cut across my brain. The last time she had insisted we talk in her room, was during my first year of university. My aunt in Greece had died suddenly.

...

‘Please Panagiotis, sit down’.

Mum always called me by my Greek name in moments of significance. It had been there in hospital during emergencies, in Church during baptisms and funerals, and at home during lectures for teenage misbehaviour. I didn’t mind it, but I knew what it meant. Even after all this time, those memories are with me, every day of every week.

Mum took up position on the edge of the bed, her bare feet resting on a thick blue rug. Looking down at her hands, she began.

PETER PAPATHANASIOU
Extract from *Little One*, 2019
Allen & Unwin Australia
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¹ Greek for ‘come’ or ‘come on’

End of Text 3

Text 4 – Poem

The novel

‘Only they don’t know / that this silence is what they yearn for.’
So there’s a man, or a woman, okay,
a person, and this person has a problem.
Not so much a problem as a yearning.
They live in a city but yearn for
the quiet of the countryside. No,
they yearn for the geometry, the voltage,
the violent anonymity of the city. Or
they yearn for the selfish, fat simplicity
of their childhood. Okay, something
more specific. They yearn for the silence
that followed the call of the mother-owl
out across the misted glade that morning
in June. Or the silence of a blown-out
filament like a ruined suspension bridge
in a snow globe without snow.
That silence. That is what the person
yearns for. Only they don’t know
that this silence is what they yearn for.
Instead they cast around, throwing
their yearning over everything
like holy water, not knowing that
the attainment of surrogate objects
of desire only frustrates or aggravates
their yearning, since the act
of attainment itself eliminates an object
from the category of desire, throwing it
into severe relief, so that immediately
it takes on a figurine aspect,
a repulsive resemblance of the silent
moment that the person does not
know they yearn for. Thus abandoned,
the search continues, the world always
ready with fresh and bright distractions.
And this person is just like us.
It could be us. Only it isn’t.

Text 4 continues on page 9

Text 4 (continued)

But you do know this person.
I can tell you that much.
Though of course, I needn't tell you.
You know exactly who I'm talking about.

JACK UNDERWOOD
in Granta – Vol. 150, 2020
Granta Publications
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End of Text 4

Text 5 – Fiction extract

The Ministry of Utmost Happiness

Where do old birds go to die?

She lived in the graveyard like a tree. At dawn she saw the crows off and welcomed the bats home. At dusk she did the opposite. Between shifts she conferred with the ghosts of vultures that loomed in her high branches. She felt the gentle grip of their talons like an ache in an amputated limb. She gathered they weren't altogether unhappy at having excused themselves and exited from the story. When she first moved in, she endured months of casual cruelty like a tree would – without flinching. She didn't turn to see which small boy had thrown a stone at her, didn't crane her neck to read the insults scratched into her bark. When people called her names – clown without a circus, queen without a palace – she let the hurt blow through her branches like a breeze and used the music of her rustling leaves as balm to ease the pain.

It was only after Ziauddin, the blind imam¹ who had once led the prayers in the Fatehpuri Masjid², befriended her and began to visit her that the neighbourhood decided it was time to leave her in peace.

One morning, while she read the newspaper aloud to him, the old imam, who clearly hadn't been listening, asked – affecting a casual air – “Is it true that even the Hindus among you are buried, not cremated?” Sensing trouble, she prevaricated. “True? Is what true? What is Truth?”

Unwilling to be deflected from his line of inquiry, the imam muttered a mechanical response. “Sach Khuda hai. Khuda hi Sach hai.” Truth is God. God is Truth. The sort of wisdom that was available on the backs of the painted trucks that roared down the highways. Then he narrowed his blindgreen eyes and asked in a slygreen whisper: “Tell me, you people, when you die, where do they bury you? Who bathes the bodies? Who says the prayers?”

Anjum said nothing for a long time. Then she leaned across and whispered back, untree-like, “Imam Sahib, when people speak of colour – red, blue, orange, when they describe the sky at sunset, or moonrise during Ramzaan³ – what goes through your mind?”

Having wounded each other thus, deeply, almost mortally, the two sat quietly side by side on someone's sunny grave, haemorrhaging. Eventually it was Anjum who broke the silence. “You tell me,” she said. “You're the Imam Sahib, not me. Where do old birds go to die? Do they fall on us like stones from the sky? Do we stumble on their bodies in the streets? Do you not think that the All-Seeing, Almighty One who put us on this Earth has made proper arrangements to take us away?”

Text 5 continues on page 11

Text 5 (continued)

That day the imam's visit ended earlier than usual. Anjum watched him leave, tap-tap-tapping his way through the graves, his seeing-eye cane making music as it encountered the empty booze bottles and discarded syringes that littered his path. She didn't stop him. She knew he'd be back. No matter how elaborate its charade, she recognised loneliness when she saw it. She sensed that in some strange tangential way, he needed her shade as much as she needed his. And she had learned from experience that Need was a warehouse that could accommodate a considerable amount of cruelty.

Even though Anjum's departure from the Khwabgah⁴ had been far from cordial, she knew that its dreams and its secrets were not hers alone to betray.

ARUNDHATI ROY

Extract from *The Ministry of Utmost Happiness*, 2017

Penguin Random House UK

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- ¹ an Islamic leadership position
² a 17th Century mosque in Delhi, India
³ Islamic holy month for Muslims
⁴ sleeping quarters; a dormitory

End of Text 5

Section II

The prescribed texts for Section II are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Anthony Doerr, *All the Light We Cannot See*
 - Amanda Lohrey, *Vertigo*
 - George Orwell, *Nineteen Eighty-Four*
 - Favel Parrett, *Past the Shallows*

- **Poetry**
 - Rosemary Dobson, *Rosemary Dobson Collected*
 - The prescribed poems are:
 - * *Young Girl at a Window*
 - * *Over the Hill*
 - * *Summer's End*
 - * *The Conversation*
 - * *Cock Crow*
 - * *Amy Caroline*
 - * *Canberra Morning*
 - Kenneth Slessor, *Selected Poems*
 - The prescribed poems are:
 - * *Wild Grapes*
 - * *Gulliver*
 - * *Out of Time*
 - * *Vesper-Song of the Reverend Samuel Marsden*
 - * *William Street*
 - * *Beach Burial*

- **Drama**
 - Jane Harrison, *Rainbow's End*, from Vivienne Cleven et al., *Contemporary Indigenous Plays*
 - Arthur Miller, *The Crucible*

- **Shakespearean Drama**
 - William Shakespeare, *The Merchant of Venice*

Section II prescribed texts continue on page 13

Section II prescribed texts (continued)

- **Nonfiction**
 - Tim Winton, *The Boy Behind the Curtain*
The prescribed chapters are:
 - * *Havoc: A Life in Accidents*
 - * *Betsy*
 - * *Twice on Sundays*
 - * *The Wait and the Flow*
 - * *In the Shadow of the Hospital*
 - * *The Demon Shark*
 - * *Barefoot in the Temple of Art*
 - Malala Yousafzai and Christina Lamb, *I am Malala*
- **Film**
 - Stephen Daldry, *Billy Elliot*
- **Media**
 - Ivan O'Mahoney, *Go Back to Where You Came From*
The prescribed episodes are:
 - * *Series 1: Episodes 1, 2 and 3*
 - and
 - * *The Response*
 - Lucy Walker, *Waste Land*